

Overview of Course & Objectives

Course Overview

Each week, the course deepens students' engagement with Muhammad's framework, gradually unfolding the five pursuits of joy, identity, skills, intellect, and criticality. Students begin by reflecting on their own literacy narratives, considering how their personal experiences with literacy shape their identity. As the course progresses, they explore literacy as a skill-building practice, focusing on the intellectual development necessary to navigate different literacy forms, such as digital and culturally responsive literacy practices.

By mid-course, students will critically analyze literacy's intersections with power, identity, and agency, examining how literacy practices are influenced by and influence social and political structures. In doing so, they will connect historical developments in literacy with contemporary practices.

The course culminates in a literacy pursuit project that draws directly from Muhammad's framework, encouraging students to integrate the five pursuits of joy, identity, skills, intellect, and criticality into professional literacy practice. Through this final project, students will apply their learning to create a mini-unit that promotes self-determination, empowerment, and social change embodying the pursuits of joy, identity, skills, intellect and criticality.

Course Learning Objectives:

1. **Analyze Literacy as a Social Practice:** Critically analyze the social, cultural, and political dimensions of literacy, examining how it functions as a tool for both empowerment and marginalization across various historical and contemporary context
2. **Synthesize Theory into Equitable Design:** Integrate the diverse range of theories explored throughout the course to design instructional materials that promote criticality, intellect, and social change
3. **Evaluate the Intersections of Power and Identity:** Reflect on how personal and community literacy narratives shape individual identity, collective agency, and social change

Course Learning Outcomes

1. **Construct a Reflective Literacy Narrative:** Produce a narrative that compares personal literacy journeys with community experiences to understand the broader societal implications of literacy
2. **Execute a Joy-Oriented Literacy Project:** Create a project that embodies self-determination and liberation, designed to be shared with an authentic audience to promote social change.
3. **Critique Literacy as a Mechanism of Power:** Conduct a critical analysis of a social justice issue to evaluate how language accessibility and literacy levels influence public discourse and community empowerment.
4. **Design a Responsive Mini-Unit:** Develop a comprehensive, culturally and historically responsive literacy mini-unit that demonstrates the ability to engage learners through meaningful, identity-focused instruction.